

Distinct sums of square roots

Quantitative asymptotics and inverse indices for A397045

Report 172

3 October 2026

Abstract

Let $a(n)$ count the distinct values in $[n, n+1)$ representable as finite sums of square roots of positive integers. We identify it exactly with a cumulative partition count over the real part sizes $\sqrt{d}$, for squarefree $d \geq 2$. This proves the logarithmic conjecture for OEIS A397045, with error $\mathcal{O}(n^{1/3})$ and constant $(81\zeta(3)/\pi^2)^{1/3}$. A first Edgeworth comparison gives an exact-product saddle approximation with relative error $\mathcal{O}(n^{-1/3})$, valid at atomic endpoints, and an implicit inverse with additive error $\mathcal{O}(1)$. An uncanceled pole at a least-positive-height zeta zero rules out every equivalent $Cn^\beta \exp(Kn^{2/3})$, unconditionally and without a simplicity assumption. The leading law and qualitative exact-saddle theory are classical; our scope is a self-contained quantitative specialization, endpoint-sensitive inversion and the stated obstruction. The reproducible companion uses rational root enclosures and separates bounded exact verification from noncertified floating-point diagnostics.

[write] **Status and trust boundary, added 6 October 2026, batch 109.** This is bundle Report 172 of an external AI-assisted research session, filed in ProveIt as the single-source research report **a397045-square-root-sums** (provenance, the sources as the write read them, what was checked, relation to the repository, the collected non-claims and the reading conventions are in Section 1.1). It is unrefereed and not formalized. Its author line and its PDF author field are empty, and the title block reads “Report 172”: it names no person or tool. *What rests on what.* Theorems 1.1, 1.2, 1.3 and 1.4 have complete conventional proofs in the text: linear independence of square roots of squarefree integers, Möbius counting, Rankin and Chebyshev bounds, a smoothing lemma for a signed comparator with a first Edgeworth term, and a Mellin argument at a zeta zero of least positive height, which uses only standard facts about the zeros of ζ (their existence, and no zero on the real segment of the critical strip). No proof uses a computation. The leading law is a specialization of Kohlbecker’s 1958 theorem and the qualitative saddle equivalent is Ingham’s, as the source says (Section 9). The exact values $a(n)$, $n \leq 35$, come from a bounded enumeration with rational root enclosures, rerun at intake and by the write; every decimal is a diagnostic. The write adds Remarks 1.5, 2.1 and 7.1 (the OEIS entry quoted, with its conjecture proved; the entry’s cumulative comment corrected, with a counterexample and an exact count of the model it names; the inverses against the transseries volume) and dated notes. No statement, proof or number of the source was changed.

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1 Results and their scope

The sequence [A397045](#) begins

$$3, 7, 17, 35, 76, 148, 295, 564, 1068, 1965, \dots$$

with index origin $n = 1$. Its entry records a June 2026 conjecture about $\log a(n)$ [1]. Define

$$c = \frac{1}{\zeta(2)}, \quad A = \frac{2\zeta(3)}{\zeta(2)}, \quad K = 3 \left(\frac{A}{4} \right)^{1/3} = \left(\frac{81\zeta(3)}{\pi^2} \right)^{1/3} = 2.1447175229\dots \quad (1.1)$$

Let $\mathcal{D}$ denote the squarefree integers $d \geq 2$, and let

$$N(x) = \# \left\{ (m_d)_{d \in \mathcal{D}} : m_d \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}, \quad \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} m_d \sqrt{d} < x \right\}. \quad (1.2)$$

All vectors have finite support, and the zero vector is included when $x > 0$. We put $N(x) = 0$ for $x \leq 0$, and write $N_{\leq}(x)$ for the weak-inequality version.

Theorem 1.1 (Exact identity and logarithmic law). *For every integer $n \geq 1$,*

$$a(n) = N(n+1) = N_{\leq}(n+1), \quad \log a(n) = K(n+1)^{2/3} + \mathcal{O}(n^{1/3}). \quad (1.3)$$

In particular $\log a(n) \sim Kn^{2/3}$, proving the conjectured constant.

For real $t > 0$ define the convergent logarithm of a product

$$F(t) = - \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} \log(1 - e^{-t\sqrt{d}}), \quad Z(t) = e^{F(t)}. \quad (1.4)$$

There is a unique $t = t(x) > 0$ satisfying $-F'(t) = x$ for every $x > 0$.

Theorem 1.2 (Quantitative exact-product saddle). *As real $x \rightarrow \infty$, with $t = t(x)$,*

$$N(x) = \frac{\exp(F(t) + tx)}{t\sqrt{2\pi F''(t)}} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(t)\}, \quad t \sim (2A/x)^{1/3}. \quad (1.5)$$

The same formula holds for $N_{\leq}(x)$, including at an atom. Its relative remainder is $\mathcal{O}(x^{-1/3})$.

The exact scalar information is kept inside F and its derivatives. Formula (1.5) is not a power-series coefficient extraction, since the support of the measure is real and atomic.

Theorem 1.3 (Inverse indices). *For $y \rightarrow \infty$, put $J(y) = \min\{n \geq 1 : a(n) \geq y\}$. Then*

$$J(y) = \left(\frac{\log y}{K} \right)^{3/2} + \mathcal{O}(\log y). \quad (1.6)$$

For the more accurate implicit inverse, set

$$H(x) = F(t(x)) + t(x)x - \log t(x) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi F''(t(x))). \quad (1.7)$$

The function H is eventually strictly increasing. If $X(y)$ is its eventually unique solution to $H(X) = \log y$, then

$$J(y) + 1 = X(y) + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (1.8)$$

These are asymptotic brackets, not exact floor or ceiling rules.

Theorem 1.4 (Obstruction to a pure equivalent). *There are no constants $C > 0$ and $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$ such that*

$$a(n) \sim Cn^{\beta} \exp(Kn^{2/3}). \quad (1.9)$$

This assertion is unconditional. It uses neither the Riemann hypothesis nor simple zeta zeros.

Attribution. Kohlbecker’s 1958 theorem applies to arbitrary positive real parts and already implies the leading logarithmic equivalent [3, Main Theorem and Corollary 1]. Ingham’s Laplace–Stieltjes theory gives a qualitative exact-saddle equivalent; Section 9 checks the required complex bound rather than inferring it from positivity. A modern conceptual precedent is the squarefree integer-partition work of Dong, Robles, Zaharescu and Zeindler [7, Section 6], where zeta-zero terms are retained in an implicit saddle. Their integer part spectrum is different. The present report claims neither a new general partition theorem nor exhaustive literature priority. Its stronger content is the quantitative specialization, inverse error, and the precise impossibility result above.

Remark 1.5 ([write] The OEIS entry, quoted, 6 October 2026). The entry was read on 6 October 2026 in the OEIS internal format (revision #27, 17 June 2026); the quotations are verbatim.

- Name: “Number of distinct values in the interval $[n, n+1)$ that can be represented as a sum of square roots of positive integers.”, offset 1, by Ali Sada (14 June 2026); data 3, 7, 17, 35, 76, $\dots$, 428363342 (35 terms; $a(11)$ – $a(13)$ from Stefano Spezia, $a(14)$ – $a(35)$ from Charles R Greathouse IV).
 - A comment: “Number of distinct values in the interval $[0, n+1)$ that can be represented as a sum of square roots of integers (or equivalently, squarefree integers) $k > 1$. – _Charles R Greathouse IV_, Jun 15 2026” (corrected in Remark 2.1).
 - A formula line: “Conjecture: $\log a(n) \sim k \cdot n^{2/3}$. Possibly $k = (81 \cdot \zeta(3) / \pi^2)^{1/3} = 2.1447\dots$ – _Charles R Greathouse IV_, Jun 15 2026”.
 - A b-file, “Table of n , $a(n)$ for $n = 1..75$ ” (Greathouse).
- (a) *The conjecture is proved.* It is literally the statement $\log a(n) \sim K n^{2/3}$ with the constant K of (1.1), and Theorem 1.1 proves it with the error $\mathcal{O}(n^{1/3})$; $K = 2.144717522977472648\dots$, so the source’s 2.1447175229... is a correct truncation. As the source says, the law with this constant was already a consequence of classical theory: the write read Kohlbecker’s Main Theorem and Corollary 1 [3], pp. 362–363, which allow any set of positive real part sizes; with $n(u) = B(u) \sim cu^2$ (his $\alpha = 2$, $L = c$) his saddle relation is $u = 4c\zeta(3)s_u^{-3}$ and his conclusion is $\log P(u) \sim \frac{3}{2}us_u = \frac{3}{2}(4c\zeta(3))^{1/3}u^{2/3} = Ku^{2/3}$ for the cumulative count P of his introduction, which is N here up to the endpoint convention. The entry still states a conjecture; nothing was submitted to the OEIS.
- (b) *The b-file.* The write retrieved the b-file (75 terms). Its first 35 terms equal the data and the source’s fixture, and it is strictly increasing (as it must be, Remark 2.1(c)). Its terms $a(36), \dots, a(75)$, which the source did not retrieve, were not recomputed; they are used only in the diagnostic note at the end of Section 10.

1.1 Provenance, sources and reading conventions

[write] **Added 6 October 2026, batch 109.** *Provenance.* This report is Report 172 of the session bundle that ProveIt’s docs/incoming intake processed as batch 109: the archive `Distinct_Square_Root_Sums_Asymptotics_and_Inverses_Source.zip` (565,603 bytes, SHA-256 0b71479e336a...cf0efbec3d08, 23 files, no wrapper directory), arrival commit 60f54ea06, placed in f7e9e5c2f. The text is the delivered `Report172.tex` (869 lines, dated 3 October 2026), shipped as `article.tex`. The programs are shipped under

code/ (the root build.py as code/build.py), the fixtures and generated outputs as data/fixtures-* and data/generated-*, BUILD-INFO.json and requirements.txt under data/, sources/source_provenance.json as data/sources-source_provenance.json, and the access record sources/REFERENCES.md at the root as sources-REFERENCES.md (the report README maps every name). The fixture-hash file fixtures/SHA256.json is shipped as data/fixtures-SHA256.json because the companion reads it. Not shipped, and retrievable from the arrival commit: the delivered 20-page PDF, the checksum manifest SHA256SUMS.json (22 entries, verified at placement) and the delivered README, replaced by the report README. The package records no ProveIt commit and names no repository path; it carries no “prepared for private review” line and no personal data. It is a single-source report, so no merge choice was made. The write prefixed the 90 delivered labels with srs: and updated the 84 references to them; it added this subsection, the notes marked [write] and Remarks 1.5, 2.1 and 7.1, each the last statement of its section, and inserted nothing before a delivered display, table or statement, so every theorem, section, equation and table of the source keeps its delivered number. In the preamble it loads float before hyperref, which removes two duplicate PDF destinations that a MiKTeX build of the delivered text reports.

The sources, as the write read them (6 October 2026).

- OEIS A397045 in the internal format, and its b-file (Remark 1.5).
- Kohlbecker [3], the publisher’s PDF (the source read a transcription): the introduction, pp. 346–347, and the Main Theorem and Corollaries 1 and 1*, pp. 362–363.
- Bringmann, Jennings-Shaffer and Mahlburg [5], arXiv:1910.03036v3, Section 4: Theorem 4.1, Ingham’s theorem with hypotheses (a)–(d) on the phase and multiplier and (i)–(ii) on the transform, the conclusion having the factor $1/(\beta(x)\sqrt{2\pi\phi''(\beta(x))})$; and Theorem 4.2. These are the hypotheses Section 9 checks, with $\phi = F$, $\lambda = 1$, $\beta = t(x)$: (b) and (c) are its display after (9.1), (d) follows from (9.1), (i) holds because $Z - 1 \sim Z = e^F$ on the narrow wedge, and (ii) is the radial bound (9.3) on every fixed sector. (Corrected after the independent check of 7 October 2026: the letters λ and β are not those of [5, Theorem 4.1], which writes the multiplier χ and the inverse function of $-\varphi'$ as ψ ; its conclusion carries $\chi(\psi(x))/(\psi(x)\sqrt{2\pi\varphi''(\psi(x))})$, and here $\varphi = F$, $\chi = 1$, $\psi(x) = t(x)$. In [5], λ and β are parameters of their Theorem 1.1. The hypotheses are as stated.)
- Dong, Robles, Zaharescu and Zeindler [7], arXiv:2412.20101v1, Section 6: the Mellin integrand $\Gamma(s)\zeta(s+1)\zeta(s)/\zeta(2s)$ of their (6.10) for partitions into squarefree parts, the explicit formula over the zeta zeros of Lemma 6.2 (stated, “for notational ease”, for simple zeros; their Remark 6.1 says the assumption can be relaxed) and the saddle formula of Lemma 6.8. The source’s account of them in Section 11 is accurate.
- The transseries volume Analysis/Transseries/docs/series-and-transseries/Transseries_And_Inversion/transseries_and_inversion.tex: p0:def:three-inverses, p0:thm:staircase, p0:thm:lambert-core, p0:prop:factorial-core, plt:def:lw-monomial-log-datum and plt:thm:lw-template, read for Remark 7.1.
- Not read by the write: Ingham’s 1941 paper, Agarwala and Auluck [6], the entry A000333 and the DLMF page [8]; the source’s account of them is reported, not confirmed.

What was checked at intake. The batch-109 dossier read the manuscript and found no error; it checked the Mellin factor (8.1) and the pole argument of Lemma 8.1, the two values below 3 by which the entry’s comment fails (Remark 2.1), and K , and it reran the companion on copies: exact and cpp--n20 identical to the delivered outputs, the optional full cpp--n35--allow-full run (3.6 s, status PASS, 428,363,342 vectors, 788 generators, no ambiguous comparison, all 35 terms equal to the fixture), and diagnostics equal up to the last binary64 digits; test_companion.py and test_build.py fail on Windows at their symlink guards. *What the write checked.* Every proof line by line, with no mathematical error found: the decomposition $k = b^2d$ and (2.2); the bound $|E(u)| \leq 4u$ of (3.2) (and, numerically, at every jump $u = \sqrt{d}$, $d < 4 \cdot 10^5$, where $|E(u)|/u \leq 0.86$); (3.5) and the three kernel integrals of Lemma 3.1, including the error bound (3.9); the Rankin and Chebyshev bounds and the choice $t = t_0(1 + Dt_0)$; the product formula behind (5.2), (5.4) and $I(v) \rightarrow 3c/2$; the removal of smoothing in Lemma 6.1 (the inequality $(1 - 2p)V \leq B_T + MC_a/T$); the central and tail ranges of Lemma 6.2; the tilt identity (6.10) and $I_0(a)$, $I_3(a)$; H' in (7.3); the saddle values (8.4) and

the Laplace constant (8.5); the Mellin continuation argument of Section 8; Kohlbecker’s specialization; and the Gaussian route of Appendix A (the exponent identity $-h^2/2 = -10L$ and the tail bound (A.12)). With its own code (Python 3.14.4, mpmath 1.3.0) it recomputed A and K , the 35 terms of the first table against the b-file, the diagnostics table to every printed digit, and the integer-radical counts of Remark 2.1 by brute force; and it reran the companion from the shipped files (README, Route B): `exact` and `cpp--n20` byte-identical to the shipped outputs, `cpp--n35--allow-full` PASS in about 3 s (MinGW-w64 g++ 16.1.0) with the counts above, `diagnostics` within $4 \cdot 10^{-15}$ of the shipped values, and `test_companion.py` failing at its broken-symlink guard on Windows. Finite and floating computations are observations, not certificates.

Relation to the repository. Before batch 109 no file of the repository named A397045, and no report counted sums of square roots by value. In the same directory of the collection (`oeis-sequence-asymptotics/`), the reports `a097356-sqrt-restricted-partitions` and `a022629-distinct-partition-norms` use the same toolkit (an exact saddle with an Edgeworth term and integer inverses) for different integer-part products, and `a126764-lconvex-polyominoes` and `a022629-distinct-partition-norms` also cite Ingham’s theorem; no result is shared, so no reciprocal note is proposed. No statement of this report is formalized in Lean or Rocq, and its place in the collection confers no formal status. The inverses of Section 7 are compared with the transseries volume in Remark 7.1.

[write] **What is not claimed, collected from the source.** The leading logarithmic law is a specialization of Kohlbecker’s theorem and the qualitative exact-saddle equivalent is Ingham’s; no new general partition theorem and no exhaustive literature priority is claimed (“A bounded search did not locate an earlier treatment . . . This is not an exhaustive novelty claim”). Dong, Robles, Zaharescu and Zeindler are conceptual prior art for zeta zeros in implicit saddles, with a different spectrum. The inverse brackets are asymptotic: no numerical constant, finite threshold or exact rounding rule is supplied, and a numerical root of $H(X) = \log y$ is not a guaranteed rounding instruction. The truncation tail bound controls omitted terms only, not rounding, the root solve or their propagation; all floating diagnostics are noncertified. Section 8 gives no pointwise formula over the zeta zeros, no RH-scale remainder and no transseries, and “does not deny the weaker relation $F(t) \sim A/t^2$ ”. No exact data beyond $n = 35$ are claimed (the source did not retrieve the b-file); fresh default coverage is claimed only to $n = 20$. The source made no OEIS submission, publication, author contact or repository edit. The write adds: its own checks are floating or finite; Remark 2.1 corrects a comment of the OEIS entry, not the source; Remark 7.1 claims no novelty for any inversion.

Reading conventions (letters the source reuses, with the tempting false readings; no symbol of the source was renamed; symbols of the transseries volume carry the subscript “vol” in Remark 7.1).

Symbol	Meaning here (where)	Not to be read as
$K, \mathcal{K}, K_T$	the constant (1.1); the smoothing kernel of Lemma 6.1 and its scaling $\mathcal{K}_T$	each other; the volume’s K_{vol}
$A, \mathcal{A}$	$2\zeta(3)/\zeta(2)$; a cumulative distribution function (Lemma 6.1)	each other
$a, a(n)$	$t\sqrt{v}$ (Section 6), also a fixed shift in the proof of Lemma 6.1; the counts	each other; the volume’s a_{vol}
H, H_3	the implicit-inverse function (1.7); the Hermite polynomial (6.6)	each other
$m(t), m_d, m_1, m$	the tilted mean; multiplicities; the unit coefficient (2.2); the multiplicity of the zero ρ	each other
$v(t), v, u$	the variance F'' ; the argument of $I(v)$ in (5.4); the Fourier variable, also a radical size u in $B(u)$	each other
$D, \mathcal{D}$	a fixed constant (Section 4); $\mathcal{A} - G$ (Lemma 6.1); an integer cutoff (10.2); $\mathcal{D}$ is the set of squarefree $d \geq 2$	each other
$E, \mathbb{E}$	the counting error (3.2); expectation	each other
$R(t), R_t(u)$	the remainder in (3.5) and (9.1); a Taylor remainder (6.8)	each other
$B(u), B_0, B_T$	the generator count; $4\zeta(2)$; a smoothed supremum (6.2)	each other; the volume’s B_{vol}
$G, G(y), g_t$	a standard normal (Appendix A); the comparator distribution function; the Edgeworth density	each other
$\Delta, \delta, \delta(\cdot)$	a sector parameter, also a CDF distance in (6.11); the smoothing width (Appendix A); a point mass in (2.3)	each other
h, h_1, h_2, L	$\sqrt{20L}$ and $L = \log(1/t)$ (Appendix A); the kernels of Lemma 3.1	the volume’s $L_{\text{vol}}, h_{\text{vol}}$
q, Q, Q_r	$ u $ (Section 3), also $e^{-t\lambda}$ (Section 5); the denominator 2^b (10.1); the angular function of Section 9	each other
c, c_0, c_*, c_1	$1/\zeta(2)$; the Chebyshev multiple; the kernel normalization; a Gaussian rate	each other
t, T, J	the saddle; a Fourier cutoff; the inverse index	each other; the volume’s t_{vol}
ρ, ν	a zeta zero of least positive height; the atomic counting measure (2.3)	the volume’s $\rho_{\text{vol}}, \nu_{\mathcal{A}}$

2 Canonical vectors and endpoint conventions

Every positive integer has a unique decomposition $k = b^2d$, with d squarefree. Thus every represented value can be written as

$$m_1 + \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} m_d \sqrt{d}, \quad m_1, m_d \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}. \quad (2.1)$$

The radicals of distinct squarefree positive integers, including $\sqrt{1} = 1$, are linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$. To recall the argument, collect the finitely many primes involved. In their multiquadratic field the products of distinct prime square roots form the character basis for the sign-change Galois group. Averaging a putative linear relation against each character extracts its coefficient. The coefficients all vanish.

Consequently (2.1) is unique. Moreover a nonzero sum involving only $d \in \mathcal{D}$ is not rational. For

each nonunit sum $s < n + 1$, there is exactly one nonnegative unit coefficient placing it in $[n, n + 1)$:

$$m_1 = n - \lfloor s \rfloor. \quad (2.2)$$

Conversely every shell value gives one such s . In particular $s = 0$ corresponds to the integer n ; the zero vector is essential. This proves the exact identity in Theorem 1.1.

There are finitely many vectors below a finite bound: only generators $\sqrt{d}$ below that bound can occur, and each multiplicity is bounded. Hence the counting measure

$$\nu = \sum_{(m_d)} \delta_{\sum m_d \sqrt{d}} \quad (2.3)$$

is locally finite, with every atom of mass one. Strict and weak counts differ by one at an atom, and agree otherwise. They agree at every positive integer, since no nonzero nonunit sum is an integer. At $x = 0$, $N(0) = 0$ and $N_{\leq}(0) = 1$. The measure ν does not depend on the continuity convention chosen for the cumulative count.

The alternate OEIS wording. The cumulative comment in the retrieved entry allows all integer radicands $k > 1$ and calls this equivalent to squarefree radicands $k > 1$. This literal equivalence fails: $\sqrt{4} = 2$ adds a value below 3. With the empty sum retained, that incorrect cumulative interpretation gives 8 instead of $a(2) = 7$. A correct alternative allows *nonsquare* integer radicands, or simply squarefree $d \geq 2$. This report uses the shell definition and the latter cumulative model; it proposes no external edit.

A different counting problem. OEIS A000333 and the work of Agarwala and Auluck [2, 6] count representations using all integer radicands. They distinguish, for example, one part $\sqrt{4}$ from two parts $\sqrt{1}$. Distinct values identify these representations. Neither their generating product nor their count can be substituted for the object here.

Remark 2.1 ([write] The entry's cumulative comment, corrected, 6 October 2026). Under Vladimir's standing rule of 4 October 2026 the source's correction of the comment quoted in Remark 1.5 stays on record, with an exact count of the model the comment names. Write $\mathcal{I}_n$ for the number of distinct values in $[0, n + 1)$ of finite sums, the empty sum included, of $\sqrt{k}$ with integers $k > 1$ (the comment's reading), and put $a(0) = 1$.

(a) For every $n \geq 1$,

$$\mathcal{I}_n = a(n) + \sum_{i=0}^{n-2} a(i). \quad (2.4)$$

Proof. Write each $k > 1$ as $b^2 d$ with d squarefree, so $\sqrt{k} = b\sqrt{d}$. If $d \geq 2$, the term adds b to m_d ; if $d = 1$, then $b \geq 2$ and the term adds b to m_1 . Hence the values are exactly the numbers $m_1 + s$ with $s = \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} m_d \sqrt{d}$ a nonunit sum and m_1 a sum of integers ≥ 2 , that is, $m_1 \in \{0, 2, 3, 4, \dots\}$; every such pair occurs (take m_d copies of $\sqrt{d}$, and $\sqrt{m_1^2}$ when $m_1 \geq 2$). By the uniqueness of (2.1), distinct pairs give distinct values. A value lies in $[0, n + 1)$ exactly when $m_1 \leq n$ and $s < n + 1 - m_1$, so $\mathcal{I}_n = N(n + 1) + \sum_{m=2}^n N(n + 1 - m)$. Finally $N(j + 1) = a(j)$ for $j \geq 1$ by Theorem 1.1, and $N(1) = 1 = a(0)$, because $\sqrt{d} \geq \sqrt{2} > 1$ leaves only the zero vector below 1. $\square$

- (b) Consequently $\mathcal{I}_1 = a(1) = 3$ and $\mathcal{I}_n > a(n)$ for every $n \geq 2$; the first values are $\mathcal{I}_n = 3, 8, 21, 46, 104$ against $a(n) = 3, 7, 17, 35, 76$ ($n \leq 5$; the write also counted $\mathcal{I}_n$ by brute force over all multisets of radicands, with the same result). At $n = 2$ the eighth value is $2 = \sqrt{4}$, as the source says. Without the empty sum the comment's model gives $\mathcal{I}_1 - 1 = 2 \neq a(1)$. So under neither convention for the empty sum is the integer-radicaud reading equivalent to the squarefree one, and the comment's "(or equivalently, squarefree integers)" is false; with *squarefree* radicands $k > 1$ and the empty sum retained, the comment is exactly Theorem 1.1's identity $a(n) = N(n+1)$, and with *nonsquare* radicands $k > 1$ it is too, since then $m_1 = 0$ always (the source's two correct alternatives). (Added after the independent check of 7 October 2026: the non-equivalence does not follow from the value at $n = 1$, where the two readings agree, with 3 values with the empty sum and 2 without. It follows from (2.4): the two counts differ by $\sum_{i=0}^{n-2} a(i) \geq 1$ for every $n \geq 2$, with the same difference whether the empty sum is counted in both or in neither. The value $\mathcal{I}_1 - 1 = 2$ shows instead that without the empty sum the comment fails as a formula for $a(n)$ under either reading.)
- (c) The same bookkeeping gives $a(n+1) - a(n) = N(n+2) - N(n+1)$, the number of nonunit sums in $[n+1, n+2)$, and this is at least one for every $n \geq 0$: for $n \leq 6$ the data show it, and for $n+1 \geq 5\sqrt{2}$ the sums $i\sqrt{2} + j\sqrt{3}$ with $i+j = M \geq 5$ fill $[M\sqrt{2}, M\sqrt{3}]$ with steps $\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2} < \frac{1}{3}$, and these intervals overlap for consecutive M because $5(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}) > \sqrt{2}$, so every interval of length one beyond $5\sqrt{2}$ contains such a sum. Hence a is strictly increasing from $n = 0$.

The comment belongs to the OEIS entry, not to the source, which proposes no edit; nothing was submitted to the OEIS.

3 Elementary estimates for the exact product

Let

$$B(u) = \#\{d \in \mathcal{D} : \sqrt{d} \leq u\}.$$

Möbius inversion gives

$$\#\{d \leq v : d \text{ squarefree}\} = \sum_{j \leq \sqrt{v}} \mu(j) \left\lfloor \frac{v}{j^2} \right\rfloor. \quad (3.1)$$

With $v = u^2$ and $q = \lfloor u \rfloor$, the floor errors cost at most u , while the omitted reciprocal-square tail costs at most u^2/q . Removing $d = 1$ costs one. For $u \geq 2$ these are together below $4u$; the bounded interval is checked directly. Therefore

$$B(u) = cu^2 + E(u), \quad |E(u)| \leq 4u \quad (u \geq 0). \quad (3.2)$$

The atomic Laplace transform is exactly

$$Z(t) = \int_{[0, \infty)} e^{-ts} \nu(ds) = \prod_{d \in \mathcal{D}} (1 - e^{-t\sqrt{d}})^{-1}. \quad (3.3)$$

For complex z with $\operatorname{Re} z > 0$ its logarithm is defined without a branch ambiguity by the absolutely convergent series

$$F(z) = \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} \sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{e^{-rz\sqrt{d}}}{r}. \quad (3.4)$$

It and its differentiated series converge locally uniformly in that half-plane. Expanding the finite products and then taking increasing limits proves (3.3); the finite transform also shows that the tilted measure used below is a probability measure.

Stieltjes integration by parts gives

$$F(t) = \int_0^\infty B(u) \frac{t}{e^{tu} - 1} du = \frac{A}{t^2} + R(t), \quad |R(t)| \leq \frac{B_0}{t}, \quad B_0 = 4\zeta(2). \quad (3.5)$$

Here $\int_0^\infty w^2/(e^w - 1) dw = 2\zeta(3)$ and $\int_0^\infty w/(e^w - 1) dw = \zeta(2)$.

Lemma 3.1 (Mean variance and higher cumulants). *Put $m(t) = -F'(t)$, $v(t) = F''(t)$, and $\kappa_j(t) = (-1)^j F^{(j)}(t)$. Then*

$$\left| m(t) - \frac{2A}{t^3} \right| \leq \frac{B_0}{t^2}, \quad \left| v(t) - \frac{6A}{t^4} \right| \leq \frac{2B_0}{t^3}, \quad (3.6)$$

$$\kappa_j(t) = (j+1)! A t^{-j-2} + \mathcal{O}_j(t^{-j-1}) \quad (j \geq 1), \quad (3.7)$$

$$|F^{(j)}(t + i\eta)| \leq \kappa_j(t) \quad (\eta \in \mathbb{R}, j \geq 1). \quad (3.8)$$

Proof. For the mean integrate $h_1(u) = u/(e^{tu} - 1)$ against $dB(u)$. It is decreasing, and $\int_0^\infty h_1(u) du = \zeta(2)t^{-2}$. Integration against the error in (3.2) yields

$$\left| \int h_1 dE \right| \leq 4 \int_0^\infty u |h_1'(u)| du = 4 \int_0^\infty h_1(u) du.$$

For the variance use $h_2(u) = u^2 e^{tu}/(e^{tu} - 1)^2$. It is decreasing because, after rescaling, it is the square of $w/(2 \sinh(w/2))$. Its integral is $2\zeta(2)t^{-3}$, giving the second bound.

For general j , expand the kernel as $\sum_{r \geq 1} r^{j-1} u^j e^{-rtu}$. For $f(u) = u^j e^{-rtu}$ the error is bounded by

$$4 \int_0^\infty u |f'(u)| du \leq 4 \{j\Gamma(j+1) + \Gamma(j+2)\} (rt)^{-j-1}. \quad (3.9)$$

Multiplication by r^{j-1} and summation gives a convergent $\zeta(2)$ error. Integration against $2cu du$ gives the main term $2c\Gamma(j+2)\zeta(3)t^{-j-2} = (j+1)! A t^{-j-2}$. Finally (3.8) follows term by term from (3.4). In particular none of these derivative statements comes from differentiating an unspecified real $\mathcal{O}$ term. $\square$

Since $m'(t) = -v(t) < 0$, m is continuous and strictly decreasing. It tends to infinity at zero by (3.6), and to zero at infinity by dominated convergence. The unique saddle satisfies

$$t(x) = \left(\frac{2A}{x} \right)^{1/3} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(x^{-1/3})\}. \quad (3.10)$$

4 An elementary proof of the logarithmic conjecture

The upper bound

$$N(x) \leq \exp(F(t) + tx) \quad (t > 0) \quad (4.1)$$

holds atom by atom and also holds for $N_{\leq}$. To obtain a lower bound, give a vector of sum s probability $e^{-ts}/Z(t)$. Equivalently the multiplicities are independent geometric variables with parameters $e^{-t\sqrt{d}}$. Their total S is finite almost surely: its finite expectation is $m(t)$. Its variance is $v(t)$.

Proposition 4.1 (Two sided finite bounds). *If $c_0 > 1$ and $x > m(t) + c_0\sqrt{v(t)}$, then*

$$N(x) \geq (1 - c_0^{-2}) \exp\{F(t) + t[m(t) - c_0\sqrt{v(t)}]\}. \quad (4.2)$$

Together with (4.1), this is a nonasymptotic pair of bounds.

Proof. Chebyshev's inequality gives probability at least $1 - c_0^{-2}$ to the interval $[m - c_0\sqrt{v}, m + c_0\sqrt{v}]$. It lies strictly below x . For each atom in it, converting probability to count multiplies by e^{F+ts} , at least $e^{F+t(m-c_0\sqrt{v})}$. Summing proves the claim. The strict hypothesis prevents losing an upper-endpoint atom. $\square$

Set $t_0 = (2A/x)^{1/3}$. Equations (3.5) and (4.1) at t_0 give

$$\log N(x) \leq 3At_0^{-2} + \mathcal{O}(t_0^{-1}) = Kx^{2/3} + \mathcal{O}(x^{1/3}).$$

For the lower bound choose $t = t_0(1 + Dt_0)$ with D a sufficiently large fixed positive constant. Expansion of (3.6) gives

$$m(t) = x - 6ADt_0^{-2} + \mathcal{O}(t_0^{-2}), \quad \sqrt{v(t)} \sim \sqrt{6A}t_0^{-2}.$$

The error constant in the first formula can be bounded independently of the fixed D for sufficiently small t_0 , after separating the $\mathcal{O}(D^2t_0^{-1})$ Taylor term. Thus choose D so that $x > m(t) + 2\sqrt{v(t)}$ eventually. Proposition 4.1 then gives

$$\log N(x) \geq F(t) + tm(t) - 2t\sqrt{v(t)} + \log(3/4) = 3At^{-2} + \mathcal{O}(t^{-1}) = Kx^{2/3} + \mathcal{O}(x^{1/3}).$$

This proves Theorem 1.1 independently of the relative approximation below. It also shows directly why the leading theorem is an application of ordinary real-part partition growth theory.

5 Characteristic control through a fixed small frequency

For the tilted sum S , put

$$\varphi_t(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_t e^{i\theta S} = Z(t - i\theta)/Z(t).$$

Only frequencies through a fixed sufficiently small $\theta_0 > 0$ require arithmetic control. The compactly supported Fourier smoothing kernel in Section 6 requires no further arithmetic bound. Appendix A gives a separate Gaussian route using $|\varphi_t| \leq 1$ at higher frequencies.

Restrict to generators $\lambda = \sqrt{d}$ in $[1/t, 2/t]$. For them $q = e^{-t\lambda} \in [e^{-2}, e^{-1}]$ and

$$\left| \frac{1 - q}{1 - qe^{i\theta\lambda}} \right|^2 = \left(1 + \frac{4q}{(1 - q)^2} \sin^2 \frac{\theta\lambda}{2} \right)^{-1}. \quad (5.1)$$

Uniform compact bounds on q give an absolute $b > 0$ such that

$$|\varphi_t(\theta)| \leq \exp \left(-b \sum_{1/t \leq \lambda \leq 2/t} \sin^2 \frac{\theta\lambda}{2} \right). \quad (5.2)$$

For example fix $\varepsilon = 1/4$. If $|\theta| \leq \varepsilon t$, the sine is bounded below by a constant times its argument in absolute value. Equation (3.2) gives order t^{-2} roots in the block, each with $\lambda^2 \asymp t^{-2}$. Hence

$$|\varphi_t(\theta)| \leq e^{-b_1\theta^2/t^4} \quad (|\theta| \leq \varepsilon t) \quad (5.3)$$

for some $b_1 > 0$ and sufficiently small t .

For larger θ in a fixed small interval, integrate $f(\lambda) = \sin^2(\theta\lambda/2)$ against B . The main term becomes

$$t^2 \sum_{1/t \leq \lambda \leq 2/t} \sin^2 \frac{\theta\lambda}{2} = I(|\theta|/t) + \mathcal{O}(t + |\theta|), \quad I(v) = \int_1^2 2cu \sin^2(vu/2) du. \quad (5.4)$$

Indeed the two boundary error terms are $\mathcal{O}(t^{-1})$. Since $|f'| \leq |\theta|/2$, the integrated error is $\mathcal{O}(|\theta|t^{-2})$. A possible atom at a block endpoint changes the sum by at most one and is absorbed.

The continuous function $I(v)$ is positive for every $v > 0$: the integrand cannot vanish identically on $[1, 2]$. Integrating the cosine part by parts gives $I(v) \rightarrow 3c/2$ as $v \rightarrow \infty$. Consequently $\inf_{v \geq \varepsilon} I(v) > 0$. Choose θ_0 sufficiently small relative to the absolute error constant in (5.4), then take t sufficiently small. Equation (5.2) yields

$$|\varphi_t(\theta)| \leq e^{-b_2/t^2} \quad (\varepsilon t \leq |\theta| \leq \theta_0) \quad (5.5)$$

for a constant $b_2 > 0$.

This is not a uniform nonlattice assertion at arbitrarily high frequencies. The restriction to $|\theta| \leq \theta_0$ is an essential part of the proof.

6 A first Edgeworth comparison and the sharp saddle theorem

An ordinary Berry–Esseen bound has absolute cumulative distribution function (CDF) error of order t , which is too large for the one-sided tilted expectation below: its main term is itself of order t . A first Edgeworth correction improves the CDF error to $\mathcal{O}(t^2)$. We prove the Fourier smoothing step for a signed comparator explicitly, because that correction need not be a probability density.

6.1 A smoothing lemma allowing signed comparators

We use the Fourier convention $\hat{\mu}(u) = \int e^{iuy} \mu(dy)$.

Lemma 6.1. *Let P be a probability measure on $\mathbb{R}$ with finite first absolute moment, characteristic function f , and right-continuous CDF $\mathcal{A}$. Let g be an integrable, possibly signed, real function satisfying*

$$\int g(y) dy = 1, \quad \int |y| |g(y)| dy < \infty, \quad \|g\|_\infty \leq M.$$

Set $G(y) = \int_{-\infty}^y g(z) dz$ and $\gamma(u) = \int e^{iuy} g(y) dy$. There is an absolute constant C such that for every $T > 0$,

$$\sup_y |\mathcal{A}(y) - G(y)| \leq C \left\{ \int_{-T}^T \left| \frac{f(u) - \gamma(u)}{u} \right| du + \frac{M}{T} \right\}. \quad (6.1)$$

The same estimate holds for the strict CDF $\mathbb{P}(Y < y)$.

Proof. Choose once and for all the even probability density

$$\mathcal{K}(w) = c_* \left(\frac{\sin(w/4)}{w/4} \right)^4,$$

with its continuous value at zero and with $c_* > 0$ normalizing its integral. It is nonnegative, has finite first absolute moment, and its Fourier transform is supported on $[-1, 1]$. Indeed, $\sin(w/4)/(w/4) = 2 \int_{-1/4}^{1/4} e^{ivw} dv$; taking the fourth convolution of the compact interval density shows that the fourth power has Fourier support in $[-1, 1]$. Also $|\hat{\mathcal{K}}| \leq 1$. Put $\mathcal{K}_T(w) = T\mathcal{K}(Tw)$ and $D = \mathcal{A} - G$.

The first-moment assumptions imply $D \in L^1(\mathbb{R})$, since the positive and negative tail integrals are bounded by the corresponding first absolute moments. Integration by parts gives, for $u \neq 0$,

$$\hat{D}(u) = -\frac{f(u) - \gamma(u)}{iu}.$$

In addition $f(0) = \gamma(0) = 1$ and finite first moments bound $(f - \gamma)/u$ near zero. Fourier inversion therefore gives

$$B_T := \|D * \mathcal{K}_T\|_\infty \leq \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-T}^T \left| \frac{f(u) - \gamma(u)}{u} \right| du. \quad (6.2)$$

Here is the removal of smoothing, with no monotonicity assumption on G . Let W have density $\mathcal{K}$, choose a fixed $a > 0$ with $p := \mathbb{P}(W > a) < 1/4$, and put $V = \|D\|_\infty$ and $C_a = \mathbb{E}(a - W)_+ < \infty$. For $h \geq 0$, monotonicity of $\mathcal{A}$ and the M -Lipschitz property of G imply

$$D(y + h) \geq D(y) - Mh.$$

Consequently

$$(D * \mathcal{K}_T)(y + a/T) = \mathbb{E}D(y + (a - W)/T) \geq (1 - p)D(y) - MC_a/T - pV.$$

If the positive supremum of D equals V , take a sequence of y approaching that supremum to obtain

$$(1 - 2p)V \leq B_T + MC_a/T.$$

If instead the negative supremum equals V , use $h \leq 0$, for which $D(y + h) \leq D(y) + M|h|$, and evaluate at $y - a/T$. Evenness of $\mathcal{K}$ gives the identical bound. This proves (6.1). Finally G is continuous; taking left limits in the bound for $\mathcal{A}$ proves the bound for the strict CDF as well. $\square$

6.2 The standardized first Edgeworth comparison

Retain the tilted probability distribution from Section 4

$$\mathbb{P}_t(S = s) = e^{-ts - F(t)}, \quad x = -F'(t), \quad v = F''(t), \quad \kappa_j = (-1)^j F^{(j)}(t).$$

Here the displayed atom formula is for each canonical vector, and Section 2 proved uniqueness of its value. Define

$$Y_t = \frac{S - x}{\sqrt{v}}, \quad \lambda_3 = \frac{\kappa_3}{v^{3/2}}, \quad \lambda_4 = \frac{\kappa_4}{v^2}.$$

Lemma 3.1 gives

$$v \sim 6At^{-4}, \quad \lambda_3 = \mathcal{O}(t), \quad \lambda_4 = \mathcal{O}(t^2), \quad |F^{(4)}(t + i\eta)| \leq \kappa_4(t). \quad (6.3)$$

Section 5 supplies constants $\varepsilon, \theta_0, b_1, b_2 > 0$ such that

$$|\varphi_t(\theta)| \leq e^{-b_1\theta^2/t^4} \quad (|\theta| \leq \varepsilon t), \quad (6.4)$$

$$|\varphi_t(\theta)| \leq e^{-b_2/t^2} \quad (\varepsilon t \leq |\theta| \leq \theta_0), \quad (6.5)$$

where $\varphi_t(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_t e^{i\theta S}$. No control at frequencies $|\theta| > \theta_0$ will be used.

Let $\phi(y) = (2\pi)^{-1/2} e^{-y^2/2}$ and $H_3(y) = y^3 - 3y$. The first-Edgeworth signed density and its Fourier transform are

$$g_t(y) = \phi(y) \left(1 + \frac{\lambda_3}{6} H_3(y) \right), \quad \gamma_t(u) = e^{-u^2/2} \left(1 + \frac{\lambda_3}{6} (iu)^3 \right). \quad (6.6)$$

Its integral is one, its first absolute moment is finite, and $\|g_t\|_\infty \leq M$ for a constant M independent of sufficiently small t . Although g_t is in general negative in a far tail, Lemma 6.1 applies directly.

Lemma 6.2. *If $G_t(y) = \int_{-\infty}^y g_t(z) dz$, then, as $t \downarrow 0$,*

$$\sup_y |\mathbb{P}_t(Y_t \leq y) - G_t(y)| = \mathcal{O}(t^2). \quad (6.7)$$

The same holds with $<$ in place of $\leq$.

Proof. Write $f_t(u) = \mathbb{E}_t e^{iuY_t}$. Its exact logarithm is

$$F(t - iu/\sqrt{v}) - F(t) - iux/\sqrt{v}.$$

Taylor's formula along the vertical segment and (6.3) give

$$\log f_t(u) = -u^2/2 + \frac{\lambda_3}{6} (iu)^3 + R_t(u), \quad |R_t(u)| \leq \frac{\lambda_4}{24} |u|^4. \quad (6.8)$$

This does not involve choosing a logarithm of a characteristic function: it is the exact analytic exponent provided by F .

Put $U = \log(1/t)$ and $T = \theta_0 \sqrt{v} \asymp t^{-2}$. On $|u| \leq U$ we have $|R_t(u)| = o(1)$ uniformly. The cubic term $b(u) = \lambda_3(iu)^3/6$ is purely imaginary. Therefore

$$|e^{b+R} - e^b| \leq e^{|R|} |R|, \quad |e^b - 1 - b| \leq |b|^2/2,$$

which imply

$$|f_t(u) - \gamma_t(u)| \leq Ct^2(|u|^4 + |u|^6)e^{-u^2/2} \quad (|u| \leq U). \quad (6.9)$$

Dividing by $|u|$ and integrating gives $\mathcal{O}(t^2)$, with no logarithmic loss.

For $U < |u| \leq \varepsilon t \sqrt{v}$, estimate (6.4) becomes $|f_t(u)| \leq e^{-c_1 u^2}$, since vt^4 stays bounded above and below by positive constants. Together with (6.6), the integral of $|f_t - \gamma_t|/|u|$ over this region is smaller than every fixed power of t . For $\varepsilon t \sqrt{v} < |u| \leq T$, estimate (6.5) bounds the contribution of f_t by

$$2e^{-b_2/t^2} \log \left(\frac{\theta_0}{\varepsilon t} \right),$$

while the contribution of γ_t is again exponentially small. For small t the cutoffs are ordered as stated, since $t\sqrt{v} \asymp t^{-1}$. Thus

$$\int_{-T}^T \frac{|f_t(u) - \gamma_t(u)|}{|u|} du = \mathcal{O}(t^2).$$

Apply Lemma 6.1: its cutoff cost is $M/T = \mathcal{O}(t^2)$. The finite first moment of Y_t follows from $\mathbb{E}Y_t^2 = 1$. $\square$

6.3 The one sided weighted expectation and atomic endpoints

Put $a = t\sqrt{v} \asymp t^{-1}$. The exact tilt identity is

$$e^{-F(t)-tx}N(x) = \mathbb{E}_t[e^{aY_t}\mathbf{1}_{\{Y_t < 0\}}]. \quad (6.10)$$

For $N_{\leq}(x)$ use $Y_t \leq 0$ instead.

For completeness, if a probability CDF $\mathcal{A}$ and a signed comparator G have uniform difference at most Δ , and G is continuous, then

$$\left| \int_{(-\infty, 0)} e^{ay} d\mathcal{A}(y) - \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} dG(y) \right| \leq 2\Delta. \quad (6.11)$$

Indeed, integration by parts writes the first term as $\mathcal{A}(0-) - a \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} \mathcal{A}(y) dy$, and the analogous expression for G has $G(0)$ as its boundary value. The absolute error is at most $\Delta + a\Delta \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} dy = 2\Delta$. For the weak convention the boundary value is $\mathcal{A}(0)$ and the same proof works. Equivalently the weighting function has total variation two. In particular no assumption that the endpoint is non-atomic is hidden here.

By (6.7) and (6.11), the right side of (6.10) is

$$\int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} g_t(y) dy + \mathcal{O}(t^2). \quad (6.12)$$

The Gaussian part, after putting $r = -ay$, is

$$I_0(a) = \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} \phi(y) dy \quad (6.13)$$

$$= \frac{\phi(0)}{a} \int_0^{\infty} e^{-r} e^{-r^2/(2a^2)} dr = \frac{\phi(0)}{a} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(a^{-2})\}. \quad (6.14)$$

The last error follows directly from $0 \leq 1 - e^{-z} \leq z$. Likewise

$$I_3(a) = \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{ay} \phi(y) H_3(y) dy \quad (6.15)$$

$$= \frac{\phi(0)}{a} \int_0^{\infty} e^{-r} e^{-r^2/(2a^2)} \left(\frac{3r}{a} - \frac{r^3}{a^3} \right) dr = \mathcal{O}(a^{-2}). \quad (6.16)$$

Thus $\lambda_3 I_3(a)/6 = \mathcal{O}(t^3)$, and $I_0(a) = \phi(0)/a + \mathcal{O}(t^3)$. Combining this with (6.12), we obtain uniformly for real $x \rightarrow \infty$, with the unique saddle $-F'(t) = x$,

$$N(x) = \frac{e^{F(t)+tx}}{t\sqrt{2\pi F''(t)}} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(t)\}. \quad (6.17)$$

The identical estimate holds for $N_{\leq}(x)$, including at atomic endpoints. Since $t \asymp x^{-1/3}$, the relative error is $\mathcal{O}(x^{-1/3})$. This proves Theorem 1.2. The CDF error $\mathcal{O}(t^2)$ is an *absolute* error in the normalized weighted expectation, whose main term has order t ; this is why the final relative error is $\mathcal{O}(t)$, rather than $\mathcal{O}(t^2)$.

7 Inversion and usable bounds

The saddle estimates imply

$$F(t) + tx = Kx^{2/3} + \mathcal{O}(x^{1/3}), \quad (7.1)$$

$$-\log t - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi v(t)) = \mathcal{O}(\log x),$$

$$\log N(x) = H(x) + \mathcal{O}(t). \quad (7.2)$$

The first follows by inserting (3.10) in (3.5); the error from the saddle shift is harmless at this order. Replacing $x = n + 1$ by n in the leading logarithm changes it by $\mathcal{O}(n^{-1/3})$, smaller than the proved error.

Differentiate the exact saddle equation. Since $m' = -v$ and $v_t = F''' = -\kappa_3$,

$$t'(x) = -\frac{1}{v}, \quad H'(x) = t + \frac{1}{tv} - \frac{\kappa_3}{2v^2} = t + \mathcal{O}(t^3) > 0 \quad \text{eventually.} \quad (7.3)$$

In particular H is eventually increasing and unbounded. Let $X = X(y)$ solve $H(X) = \log y$ on that branch. For each fixed $C > 0$, the saddle varies by a relative $o(1)$ on $[X - C, X + C]$, because $t'(x) = -1/v = \mathcal{O}(t^4)$. Consequently

$$H(X \pm C) - H(X) = \pm C t(X)(1 + o(1)).$$

The error in (7.2) is bounded by a fixed constant times $t(X)$. Choosing C larger than that constant yields

$$N(X - C) < y < N(X + C)$$

for all sufficiently large y . Sampling at integers $x = n + 1$ adds at most a bounded amount to the bracket. Thus

$$J(y) + 1 = X(y) + \mathcal{O}(1),$$

which proves (1.8). The bound is asymptotic; no numerical constant, finite threshold or exact rounding rule is supplied.

For the explicit estimate set $x_0 = (\log y/K)^{3/2}$. The derivative of the leading logarithm is $(2K/3)x^{-1/3}$; dividing the error $\mathcal{O}(x^{1/3})$ by it gives $\mathcal{O}(x^{2/3}) = \mathcal{O}(\log y)$. Equivalently evaluate the logarithmic bounds at $x_0 \pm C \log y$ and use monotonicity. This proves (1.6) and Theorem 1.3.

What is computable and what is certified. The positive product and its derivatives make H numerically accessible. The asymptotic $\mathcal{O}$ constants here have not been converted into sharp numerical constants or a finite threshold, so a numerical root of $H(X) = \log y$ is an approximation, not a guaranteed rounding instruction. To certify finite inequalities one may enclose the product and moments and use Proposition 4.1 and (4.1). The supplied floating-point saddle routine does not perform that interval-certified step.

Remark 7.1 ([write] The inversions and the transseries volume, 6 October 2026). Compared, statement by statement, with `Analysis/Transseries/docs/series-and-transseries/Transseries_And_Inversion/transseries_and_inversion.tex`; symbols of the volume carry the subscript “vol”.

- (a) *Instance.* The index $J(y)$ of Theorem 1.3 is the integer staircase N_* of `p0:def:three-inverses` with $A_n = a(n)$ and $n_1 = 1$ (a is strictly increasing, Remark 2.1(c)), for $y \geq a(1)$; so `p0:thm:staircase(1)` gives $J(y) = \lceil \nu_{\mathcal{A}}(y) \rceil$ for every admissible interpolation $\mathcal{A}$. The source does not use this.

- (b) *Theorem 1.3: not an instance.* Both brackets, (1.6) with error $\mathcal{O}(\log y)$ and (1.8) with error $\mathcal{O}(1)$, are direct estimates of J , proved from the monotonicity of N and the saddle formula; they are not two-ceiling brackets, and an $\mathcal{O}(1)$ error does not determine J , so neither has the form of `p0:thm:staircase(2)` or (3); the source says they are “not exact floor or ceiling rules”. A second route to (1.8) through `p0:thm:staircase(1)` (added by the write): let $\mathcal{A}(n + \theta) = a(n)^{1-\theta} a(n+1)^\theta$ ($n \geq 1$, $0 \leq \theta \leq 1$), an admissible interpolation because a is strictly increasing, and $\nu = \nu_{\mathcal{A}}(y)$. By (7.2) at $x = n+1$, $\log a(n) = H(n+1) + \mathcal{O}(t(n+1))$, and for a C^1 function $(1-\theta)H(n+1) + \theta H(n+2) - H(n+1+\theta) = \theta(1-\theta)\{H'(\xi_2) - H'(\xi_1)\}$ with $\xi_1, \xi_2 \in [n+1, n+2]$, which is $\mathcal{O}(t(n+1))$ by (7.3). Hence $\log \mathcal{A}(x) = H(x+1) + \mathcal{O}(t(x+1))$, and $H(\nu+1) - H(X) = \log \mathcal{A}(\nu) - \log y - \{\log \mathcal{A}(\nu) - H(\nu+1)\} = \mathcal{O}(t(\nu+1))$. Since $H(x) = Kx^{2/3} + \mathcal{O}(x^{1/3})$ is eventually increasing, $\nu+1 \sim X$, so t is $t(\nu+1)(1+o(1))$ between $\nu+1$ and X , where $H' = t(1+o(1))$ by (7.3); the mean-value theorem gives $\nu+1 - X = \mathcal{O}(1)$, and $J = \lceil \nu \rceil \in [\nu, \nu+1)$ gives (1.8). This recovers the source’s $\mathcal{O}(1)$, no more.
- (c) *A trivial formal instance.* The leading inverse $(\log y/K)^{3/2}$ of (1.6) solves $Kx^{2/3} = \log y$, which is `plt:thm:lw-template` with $Z_{\text{vol}} = \log x$, $\xi_{\text{vol}} = \log \log y$ and data $(\rho_{\text{vol}}, \mu_{\text{vol}}, \beta_{\text{vol}}, B_{\text{vol}}) = (2/3, 0, \log K, 0)$, the degenerate case without logarithm or correction series; its answer is the power inverse itself. No Lambert function occurs: the leading balance has no logarithmic term, so neither `p0:thm:lambert-core` nor `p0:prop:factorial-core` is involved.
- (d) *Not shown to be an instance.* The implicit equation $H(X) = \log y$ of (1.8) is not shown to be an instance of `plt:thm:lw-template` in any chart. H is built from the exact product F , and Corollary 8.2 shows that F has no finite expansion in real powers and logarithms of t with a bounded remainder; whether H itself admits an expansion of the template’s form (H3) is not decided here. The write does not claim that it lies outside every chart.

No novelty is claimed for any of these inversions.

8 Zeta poles and the impossibility of a pure equivalent

8.1 The exact Mellin transform

For $\text{Re } s > 2$, absolute convergence of (3.4) gives

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathcal{M}(s) &= \int_0^\infty F(t) t^{s-1} dt \\
 &= \Gamma(s) \zeta(s+1) \sum_{d \in \mathcal{D}} d^{-s/2} \\
 &= \Gamma(s) \zeta(s+1) \left(\frac{\zeta(s/2)}{\zeta(s)} - 1 \right). \tag{8.1}
 \end{aligned}$$

The quotient is the squarefree Dirichlet series, and the subtraction removes $d = 1$. Both features are essential; replacing this factor by $\zeta(s/2)$ discards the decisive singularities.

Lemma 8.1 (A surviving nonreal pole). *The meromorphic function in (8.1) has a genuine pole in $0 < \text{Re } s < 1$.*

Proof. Choose a nontrivial zeta zero ρ with the least positive imaginary part. Such a minimum exists: there are nontrivial zeros, they are isolated, there are only finitely many in a bounded portion

of the closed critical strip, and there is no accumulation on its real segment. For $0 < s < 1$ the alternating eta series is positive and $1 - 2^{1-s} < 0$, so $\zeta(s) < 0$; also $\zeta(0) \neq 0$ and $s = 1$ is a pole, not a zero. The standard zero-free boundary and existence facts are recalled in [8].

Let the multiplicity of ρ be $m \geq 1$. Its half lies in the critical strip with strictly smaller positive height, so $\zeta(\rho/2) \neq 0$. Furthermore $\Gamma(\rho)$ is finite and nonzero, and $\zeta(1+\rho) \neq 0$ because $\operatorname{Re}(1+\rho) > 1$. Thus (8.1) has a pole of order exactly m at ρ ; the subtractive constant cannot cancel its principal part. No numerical zero height, critical-line hypothesis or simplicity assumption was used. $\square$

8.2 What a hypothetical pure equivalent would imply

Suppose (1.9) held. By the exact identity and monotonicity, for large real x ,

$$a(\lfloor x \rfloor - 1) \leq N(x) \leq a(\lfloor x \rfloor).$$

For every fixed real β , the comparison $Cx^\beta e^{Kx^{2/3}}$ changes by a factor tending to one under a bounded shift. Therefore

$$N(x) \sim Cx^\beta e^{Kx^{2/3}} \quad (x \rightarrow \infty \text{ through real values}). \quad (8.2)$$

Tonelli's theorem, or integration by parts with the atomic measure, gives the identity

$$Z(t) = t \int_0^\infty e^{-tx} N(x) dx. \quad (8.3)$$

Values at endpoints do not affect this Lebesgue integral. Fix a sufficiently large lower cutoff x_* . Replace $N(x)$ by its comparison only on $[x_*, \infty)$. This avoids any artificial divergence at zero if $\beta < 0$; the bounded initial interval contributes only $\mathcal{O}(t)$ to (8.3), negligible on the exponential scale.

For completeness the real Laplace calculation is as follows. The exponent $g_t(x) = Kx^{2/3} - tx$ has unique maximum at

$$x_0 = \frac{2A}{t^3}, \quad g_t(x_0) = \frac{A}{t^2}, \quad g_t''(x_0) = -\frac{t^4}{6A}. \quad (8.4)$$

Put $x = x_0 z$. Then $g_t(x) = At^{-2}(3z^{2/3} - 2z)$, with a strict maximum at $z = 1$. Standard Gaussian scaling there, and the strict decay away from it, yield

$$t \int_{x_*}^\infty Cx^\beta e^{g_t(x)} dx \sim C(2A)^\beta \sqrt{12\pi A} t^{-3\beta-1} e^{A/t^2}. \quad (8.5)$$

The relative comparison in (8.2) is uniform for all sufficiently large x . Bounding it above and below by $1 \pm \epsilon$, then sending $\epsilon \downarrow 0$, justifies the same equivalent for $Z(t)$, including arbitrary real β . Taking logarithms gives

$$F(t) = \frac{A}{t^2} - (3\beta + 1) \log t + C_1 + o(1), \quad F(t) - A/t^2 = \mathcal{O}(1 + |\log t|). \quad (8.6)$$

8.3 The analytic continuation contradiction

Under (8.6) the expression

$$\int_0^1 [F(t) - A/t^2] t^{s-1} dt + \int_1^\infty F(t) t^{s-1} dt + \frac{A}{s-2} \quad (8.7)$$

is meromorphic on $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$ with only a possible pole at $s = 2$. The first integral is holomorphic there by locally uniform domination using (8.6). The second is entire: for $t \geq 1$, comparison of the positive series at t and 1 bounds $F(t)$ by $F(1)e^{-(t-1)\sqrt{2}}$.

For $\operatorname{Re} s > 2$, expression (8.7) equals (8.1). Meromorphic uniqueness on the connected half-plane $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$ makes them identical there. This contradicts Lemma 8.1, proving Theorem 1.4.

Corollary 8.2. *There is no representation of $F(t)$ near zero as a finite sum of terms $c_{\alpha,k}t^{-\alpha}(\log t)^k$, with $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ and nonnegative integers k , plus a bounded remainder.*

Proof. Subtract the proposed terms in the small- t Mellin integral. The bounded remainder gives a holomorphic function for $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$. Each subtracted term continues with poles only at its real exponent α , of order at most $k + 1$. The large- t integral is entire as before. This cannot account for the nonreal pole in Lemma 8.1. $\square$

This does not supply a pointwise sum over all zeta zeros, an RH-scale remainder, or a full transseries. It explains why finite real-power and logarithm terms cannot replace F in the exponential with an $o(1)$ error. This does not deny the weaker relation $F(t) \sim A/t^2$. Keeping the exact positive product in (1.5) retains the unresolved structure safely.

9 The classical exact saddle bridge

This section documents why the qualitative part of Theorem 1.2 should not be presented as a new general theorem. Ingham's 1941 theorem is available in the precise Laplace–Stieltjes form restated by Bringmann, Jennings-Shaffer and Mahlburg [5, Theorem 4.1]. It accommodates real atoms. Besides a saddle expansion it requires a radial complex majorant, which positivity alone does not establish.

On every fixed closed sector $|\arg z| \leq \arctan \Delta < \pi/2$, integration of (3.2) gives

$$F(z) = Az^{-2} + R(z), \quad R^{(j)}(z) = \mathcal{O}_{j,\Delta}(|z|^{-1-j}). \quad (9.1)$$

For $j = 0$ this follows by splitting the integral into $|z|u \leq 1$ and $|z|u > 1$ and using the positive real part of z ; derivatives follow by differentiation or Cauchy's estimate in a slightly wider sector.

Fix $r = |z|$ and put $Q_r(\theta) = \operatorname{Re} F(re^{i\theta}) - F(r)$. For a sufficiently small fixed $\epsilon < \pi/4$,

$$Q_r(0) = Q'_r(0) = 0, \quad Q''_r(\theta) = -4Ar^{-2} \cos(2\theta) + \mathcal{O}(r^{-1}) < 0 \quad (|\theta| \leq \epsilon). \quad (9.2)$$

For $\epsilon \leq |\theta| \leq \arctan \Delta$,

$$Q_r(\theta) = Ar^{-2} \{\cos(2\theta) - 1\} + \mathcal{O}_\Delta(r^{-1}) < 0.$$

Thus, for sufficiently small $|z|$ in each such sector,

$$|Z(z)| \leq Z(|z|). \quad (9.3)$$

This is the needed radial comparison; $|Z(z)| \leq Z(\operatorname{Re} z)$ would be insufficient.

Take a narrower wedge, for example $|\arg z| < \pi/8$, and set the phase equal to F and the multiplier equal to 1. In that wedge $\operatorname{Re} F(z) \rightarrow +\infty$. The distance $d(t)$ of $t > 0$ to its boundary is a fixed multiple of t . Equation (9.1) verifies the local derivative condition of Ingham's theorem, and

$$-tF'(t) \sim 2At^{-2} \rightarrow \infty, \quad \frac{-d(t)F'(t)}{t\sqrt{F''(t)}} \asymp t^{-1} \rightarrow \infty. \quad (9.4)$$

Remove the atom at zero by applying the theorem to the count of positive atoms, whose transform is $Z - 1$. On the narrow wedge $Z - 1 \sim Z$ uniformly, and (9.3) gives its radial bound with an immaterial constant. The positive-atom counting function starts at zero, as required. The theorem yields the qualitative equivalent in (1.5); adding back one atom is negligible. The Edgeworth proof in Section 6 supplies the specific remainder and deals directly with both endpoint conventions; Appendix A provides an independent weaker quantitative proof.

Kohlbecker’s real-part logarithmic theorem specializes with part density cu^2 to

$$\log N(x) \sim \frac{3}{2}(4c\zeta(3))^{1/3}x^{2/3} = Kx^{2/3}.$$

The use of that theorem here is an application, while the elementary proof in Section 4 supplies the stated error without importing its general machinery.

10 Exact computation and numerical interpretation

10.1 Bounded exact verification

The companion enumerates canonical vectors with integer arithmetic. For a fixed denominator $Q = 2^b$ it computes

$$\ell_d = \lfloor Q\sqrt{d} \rfloor = \text{isqrt}(dQ^2), \quad \frac{\ell_d}{Q} \leq \sqrt{d} < \frac{\ell_d + 1}{Q} \quad (d \in \mathcal{D}). \quad (10.1)$$

A vector then has rational lower and upper sum bounds. An interval crossing a decision boundary causes an explicit ambiguity error, never a guessed membership decision. Equal algebraic endpoints are recognized by equality of their canonical coefficient vectors. This is also how strict and weak comparisons are tested at irrational atoms.

A nondecreasing-generator recursion enumerates each vector once. Lower-bound pruning can omit only vectors already beyond the strict cutoff; a surviving ambiguous comparison aborts. A separate direct shell enumeration includes the unit generator with exact weight one and classifies values in $[n, n + 1)$ independently of (2.2). Trial-division and sieve squarefreeness checks provide separate generator checks.

The bounded default suite freshly covers the nonunit cumulative counts through $n = 20$ (458,000 vectors, 268 generators), the direct shell counts through $n = 12$ (14,155 vectors), and strict/weak endpoints

$$0, 1, \sqrt{2}, 2\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{2} + \sqrt{5}, 3, 6.$$

It checks invalid input and ambiguity failure paths, and runs normally and under optimized Python; correctness checks do not depend on removable `assert` statements.

A previously completed rational-enclosure run through $n = 35$ visited 428,363,342 vectors, had no ambiguous boundary comparisons, and matched all 35 displayed OEIS terms. The package preserves that verified fixture and an optional compiled rerun. The ordinary build does *not* repeat the 428-million-vector computation, and fresh default coverage is not claimed beyond $n = 20$.

n	$a(n)$	Verification coverage
1	3	Fresh default and historical run
5	76	Fresh default and historical run
10	1,965	Fresh default and historical run
15	34,156	Fresh default and historical run
20	458,000	Fresh default and historical run
25	5,106,583	Historical full-run fixture
30	49,469,766	Historical full-run fixture
35	428,363,342	Historical full-run fixture

Table 1: Selected exact values. The auxiliary value $a(0) = 1$ records the empty-vector convention and is not an additional OEIS positive-index term.

[write] **Rerun, 6 October 2026.** The “previously completed” run through $n = 35$ has since been repeated twice from the delivered program, on copies: at intake and by the write (`cpp--n35--allow-full`, about 3 s each with MinGW-w64 g++ on Windows): status **PASS**, 428,363,342 vectors, 788 generators, no ambiguous comparison, all 35 terms equal to the fixture. So the rows $n = 25, 30, 35$ of the table above, labelled “Historical full-run fixture”, are now also freshly reproduced; the delivered text, which claims no fresh run beyond $n = 20$, is kept as written. The OEIS b-file extends the data to $n = 75$ (Remark 1.5(b)); those terms were not recomputed.

10.2 Positive truncation tails are not full numerical certificates

For an integer cutoff $D \geq 1$, let $F_D(t)$ retain squarefree $d \leq D$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
0 \leq F(t) - F_D(t) &\leq \frac{1}{1 - e^{-t\sqrt{D}}} \sum_{d>D} e^{-t\sqrt{d}} \\
&\leq \frac{2e^{-t\sqrt{D}}}{1 - e^{-t\sqrt{D}}} \left(\frac{\sqrt{D}}{t} + \frac{1}{t^2} \right).
\end{aligned} \tag{10.2}$$

The first bound uses $-\log(1 - q) \leq q/(1 - q)$ and enlarges the squarefree set to all integers; the second integrates the decreasing function $e^{-t\sqrt{u}}$ over $[D, \infty)$. Analogous positive kernel tails can bound derivative truncation.

Equation (10.2) controls omitted positive terms in exact arithmetic. It does not control floating-point rounding, the numerical saddle solution or the propagation of those errors through H . The numerical companion labels all such evaluations diagnostic. No finite-index guarantee or sharper cumulant expansion is inferred from them.

For scale, the companion gives the following rounded double-precision diagnostics. They illustrate the advantage of retaining the product but play no role in any proof.

n	$\log a(n)$	$K(n+1)^{2/3}$	$H(n+1)$	$e^H/a(n) - 1$
5	4.330733	7.081701	4.299795	−0.030464
10	7.583248	10.607960	7.576160	−0.007062
20	13.034624	16.324866	13.029777	−0.004836
35	19.875482	23.383262	19.872006	−0.003471

Table 2: Floating-point diagnostic values, rounded to six decimals. The $n = 35$ exact denominator comes from the historical verified fixture. The table is not a certified error table.

The apparent smoothness of modest- n diagnostics cannot override the Mellin obstruction. In particular a very small observed formal correction would not prove a full smooth transseries.

[write] Rechecked, 6 October 2026. With its own code (binary64, the product truncated where $e^{-t\sqrt{d}} < 10^{-30}$, the saddle by bisection) the write reproduced every entry of the table above to the printed digits. Extended with the b-file terms, $e^{H(n+1)}/a(n) - 1$ is about -0.00277 , -0.00247 , -0.00214 at $n = 50$, 60 , 75 (rounded), and its ratio to the saddle $t(n+1)$ moves from -0.040 at $n = 5$ through -0.008 at $n = 35$ to -0.006 at $n = 75$: small and slowly varying, as the relative error $\mathcal{O}(t)$ of Theorem 1.2 allows. These are observations, not a test of the theorem, and the b-file terms beyond $n = 35$ were not recomputed.

10.3 Reproducibility and build safety

The accompanying archive contains this PDF, its standalone L^AT_EX source, exact and numerical code, fixtures, source provenance, generated verification outputs and a deterministic build script. The README specifies the bounded default commands and the separate optional full enumeration. Builds run in a fresh temporary workspace and refuse existing output destinations. They do not alter the source tree or silently overwrite prior results. Compilation checks reject unresolved references and overfull layout diagnostics; reproducibility is tested with independent clean builds. The package excludes third-party paper PDFs and private research notes.

[write] The shipped layout, 6 October 2026. In ProveIt the “accompanying archive” is not shipped as such: the delivered PDF and checksum manifest are not shipped, the README is replaced by the report README, and the programs, fixtures and outputs are shipped under `code/` and `data/` with prefixed names (Section 1.1); the delivered build and test scripts expect the delivered layout. The report README gives rerun routes that restore it on a copy.

11 Source provenance and further questions

The consulted OEIS page, opened again on 3 October 2026, agrees with the shell definition, 35 displayed terms and conjectured constant used here. Its cached page metadata need not identify its newest uncached revision. A linked table extends to $n = 75$, but it was not successfully retrieved in the source-gathering pass; this report makes no exact-data claim beyond the displayed 35-term prefix.

The relevant source access has the following limits.

- Kohlbecker’s introduction and main theorem material, including pp. 362–363, were consulted through a transcription of the scan. The publisher PDF retrieval failed. The paper explicitly permits positive real parts; attribution does not depend on claiming a directly inspected publisher scan.
- Ingham’s original 1941 scan was not retrieved. Its general theorem was checked through Bringmann–Jennings-Shaffer–Mahlburg, Section 4, Theorem 4.1. Section 9 verifies the specialized hypotheses rather than invoking only an informal real-axis version.
- Agarwala–Auluck’s 1951 scan and the discussion of formulas (26)–(28) were consulted. The count there is representation-based, and its discussion of nonintegral powers does not establish the multiplying factor required here.
- Dong–Robles–Zaharescu–Zeindler, Section 6, especially Lemmas 6.2 and 6.8, was consulted. Their squarefree integer-part Mellin factor is $\Gamma(s)\zeta(s+1)\zeta(s)/\zeta(2s)$, and they exhibit the relevance of

zeta zeros to implicit saddles. This is conceptual prior art for the warning in Section 8, not the same spectrum or a proof of our impossibility statement.

A bounded search did not locate an earlier treatment of this precise real squarefree-root spectrum with the present quantitative statements. This is not an exhaustive novelty claim, and the leading asymptotic remains classical regardless.

The following questions remain open within this report.

1. Can the relative $\mathcal{O}(t)$ error be improved further, or developed into a proved higher-order formula, while retaining uniform validity at atoms? The first Edgeworth term resolves the logarithmic loss in the Gaussian route, but a sharper theorem must still control the signed comparison, all relevant frequencies and endpoint effects rather than merely extend a formal central cumulant calculation.
2. Can one obtain a useful pointwise explicit formula for F involving zeta zeros, with an unconditional controlled remainder? The surviving-pole argument is an obstruction, not such a formula.
3. Can the asymptotic inverse bracket be made effective with practical numerical constants and a certified finite starting point? Rigorous interval evaluation of the product, derivative tails and root solve would be needed for computational certificates.
4. Can exact counting beyond the displayed prefix be accelerated without surrendering the ambiguity-abort guarantee? Meet-in-the-middle schemes would need equally careful treatment of irrational endpoints and duplicate canonical vectors.

No OEIS submission, publication, author contact or public repository edit accompanies this report.

[write] **Added 6 October 2026, under Vladimir’s standing rule of 4 October 2026.** The four questions stand as the source states them; the write found no unproved claim of the source outside them, and no claim of the source that is wrong. On question 4: the OEIS b-file (Greathouse, $n \leq 75$, Remark 1.5(b)) shows that exact counts well beyond $n = 35$ have been computed, by a method the entry does not state; the write did not verify those terms, so the question, which asks for faster counting with the ambiguity-abort guarantee, stays open. The OEIS page and the b-file were retrieved by the write (the source’s “A linked table . . . was not successfully retrieved” describes 3 October 2026), and Kohlbecker’s paper was read in the publisher’s PDF (Section 1.1). The entry’s cumulative comment is corrected in Remark 2.1.

[write] **Independent check of the write, 7 October 2026.** An adversarial check made by the intake after the write (commit `b1a39e80f`) re-derived the statements marked [write] with its own code, after fetching again A397045 (revision #27) and its b-file, the publisher’s PDF of [3] (pp. 346–347 and 362–363 rendered), [5] (v3, Section 4 rendered) and [7] (v1, Section 6). *The conjecture* (Remark 1.5(a)). The proof of Theorem 1.1 re-done (the exact identity, the Rankin bound at t_0 , the Chebyshev bound at $t_0(1 + Dt_0)$); Kohlbecker’s saddle relation $u = \alpha\Gamma(\alpha + 1)\zeta(\alpha + 1)s_u^{-\alpha-1}L(1/s_u)$ with $\alpha = 2$, $L = c$, and his $P(u) = \sum_{\nu_i \leq u} p(\nu_i) = N_{\leq}(u)$ here (every $p(\nu_i) = 1$ by linear independence); $K = 2.144717522977472648 \dots$ three ways. Remark 2.1. The proof of (2.4) re-done; by brute force over multisets of radicands (40-digit values) $\mathcal{I}_n = 3, 8, 21, 46, 104, 211$ and the squarefree counts 3, 7, 17, 35, 76, 148 for $n \leq 6$, and the shell counts $a(1), \dots, a(7)$ directly from all positive radicands; the covering constants of (c) ($\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2} = 0.3178$, $5(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{2}) - \sqrt{2} = 0.175 > 0$, while $M = 4$ would fail). One gap in the reasoning of (b), with a correct conclusion, is closed by a dated note there. Remark 7.1. (a)–(d) re-derived against the volume, including the linear-interpolation identity of (b) and the chart of (c). *Sources.* Every statement about the entry, the b-file (75 terms, the first 35 equal to the data, strictly increasing), Kohlbecker, [5] and [7] confirmed, except that the write named the letters of [5, Theorem 4.1] wrongly (corrected in Section 1.1). *Notes.* The diagnostics table to every printed digit and the write’s extension (-0.002773 , -0.002469 , -0.002139 at $n = 50, 60, 75$; ratios to t : -0.0395 , -0.0080 , -0.0064 at $n = 5, 35, 75$) from its own float64 code; $|E(u)|/u \leq 0.8597$ at the jumps $\sqrt{d}$, $d \leq 10^6$. *Provenance.*

Archive facts, the 90 delivered label numbers and 84 references (aux of a build of the delivered text, which indeed reports duplicate destinations `table.1`, `table.2`) confirmed.

A An independent Gaussian smoothing proof

This appendix gives an independent, slightly weaker relative estimate using Gaussian smoothing directly on the real atomic measure. With the same exact saddle $-F'(t) = x$, it proves

$$N(x) = \frac{e^{F(t)+tx}}{t\sqrt{2\pi F''(t)}} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(t \log(1/t))\}, \quad (\text{A.1})$$

for both cumulative conventions. The proof displays the inversion identity, integrated central errors, high-frequency tail relative to the order- t main term, and monotone removal of smoothing. The first Edgeworth argument in Section 6 removes the logarithmic loss.

A.1 An exact inversion identity for the atomic measure

Let G be standard normal, with distribution function Φ , and take any $t, \delta > 0$. For one atom at s ,

$$\frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{\exp\{(t+i\theta)(y-s) + \delta^2(t+i\theta)^2/2\}}{t+i\theta} d\theta = \Phi\left(\frac{y-s}{\delta}\right). \quad (\text{A.2})$$

One proof differentiates in y , evaluates the Gaussian Fourier transform, and fixes the integration constant by the limit at $y \rightarrow -\infty$. The exponential factor $e^{t(y-s)}$ makes that limit zero.

Define $N_\delta(y) = \mathbb{E}N(y + \delta G)$. The strict and weak conventions give the same function, since a Gaussian hits a countable set of endpoints with probability zero. Summing (A.2) gives the exact formula

$$N_\delta(y) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{\exp\{F(t+i\theta) + (t+i\theta)y + \delta^2(t+i\theta)^2/2\}}{t+i\theta} d\theta. \quad (\text{A.3})$$

The interchange is absolutely justified. The sum of the integrals of absolute values is bounded by

$$\frac{e^{ty+\delta^2 t^2/2} Z(t)}{2\pi} \int_{\mathbb{R}} \frac{e^{-\delta^2 \theta^2/2}}{|t+i\theta|} d\theta < \infty.$$

Thus no replacement of the atoms by a density is involved.

A.2 The central integral and its integrated errors

From now on let $x = m(t)$, $L = \log(1/t)$, and

$$\delta = \frac{\sqrt{20L}}{\theta_0}, \quad h = \sqrt{20L}, \quad y = x + u, \quad |u| \leq h\delta = \frac{20L}{\theta_0}. \quad (\text{A.4})$$

Keep the same saddle $t = t(x)$ at every shifted y . After extracting $e^{F(t)+ty}$ in (A.3), the integrand is

$$\frac{\exp\{F(t+i\theta) - F(t) + i\theta x\}}{t+i\theta} \exp\{-\delta^2 \theta^2/2 + i\theta(u + \delta^2 t) + \delta^2 t^2/2\}. \quad (\text{A.5})$$

For $|\theta| \leq t^2 L$, Taylor's theorem and (3.8) give

$$F(t+i\theta) - F(t) + i\theta x = -\frac{1}{2}v\theta^2 + \mathcal{O}(\kappa_3|\theta|^3), \quad v \sim 6At^{-4}, \quad \kappa_3 = \mathcal{O}(t^{-5}). \quad (\text{A.6})$$

The uniform Taylor remainder is $\mathcal{O}(tL^3) = o(1)$, so its exponential may be expanded with a uniform absolute bound. More importantly, its *integrated relative* contribution is

$$\mathcal{O}\left(\kappa_3 \frac{\int_{\mathbb{R}} |\theta|^3 e^{-v\theta^2/2} d\theta}{\int_{\mathbb{R}} e^{-v\theta^2/2} d\theta}\right) = \mathcal{O}(\kappa_3 v^{-3/2}) = \mathcal{O}(t). \quad (\text{A.7})$$

Replacing $(t + i\theta)^{-1}$ by t^{-1} costs relatively $\mathcal{O}((t\sqrt{v})^{-1}) = \mathcal{O}(t)$, since $|(t + i\theta)^{-1} - t^{-1}| \leq |\theta|/t^2$. The three extra factors in (A.5) cost, respectively,

$$\mathcal{O}(\delta^2/v), \quad \mathcal{O}((|u| + \delta^2 t)/\sqrt{v}), \quad \mathcal{O}(\delta^2 t^2), \quad (\text{A.8})$$

all $o(t)$, uniformly over the allowed shifts. The discarded Gaussian tail past $t^2 L$ is superpolynomially small because $\sqrt{v} t^2 L \asymp L$. Thus the central integral is

$$\frac{e^{F(t)+ty}}{t\sqrt{2\pi v(t)}} \{1 + \mathcal{O}(t)\}. \quad (\text{A.9})$$

The estimates use integrated Gaussian moments, not the weaker supremum $\mathcal{O}(tL^3)$ as a claimed final rate.

A.3 All complementary frequencies

Normalize the remaining integral by $e^{F(t)+ty}$ as before. From (5.3), the first range contributes at most

$$\mathcal{O}\left(t \int_L^\infty e^{-bz^2} dz\right) \quad (t^2 L < |\theta| \leq \varepsilon t). \quad (\text{A.10})$$

From (5.5), the second is

$$\mathcal{O}(t^{-1} e^{-b_2/t^2}) \quad (\varepsilon t \leq |\theta| \leq \theta_0). \quad (\text{A.11})$$

For $|\theta| \geq \theta_0$ use only $|Z(t + i\theta)| \leq Z(t)$. Since $|t + i\theta| \geq |\theta|$,

$$\int_{|\theta| \geq \theta_0} \frac{e^{-\delta^2 \theta^2/2}}{|t + i\theta|} d\theta \leq \frac{2e^{-\delta^2 \theta_0^2/2}}{\delta^2 \theta_0^2} = \mathcal{O}(t^{10}/L). \quad (\text{A.12})$$

The harmless factor $e^{\delta^2 t^2/2}$ is bounded. The normalized main term in (A.9) has order $1/(t\sqrt{v}) \asymp t$, so (A.12) has relative order $\mathcal{O}(t^9/L)$. All three complementary ranges are negligible relative to the central term. This proves (A.9) for the full smoothed integral, uniformly in $|u| \leq h\delta$.

An ordinary Berry–Esseen bound alone does not prove this estimate on the required shrinking normalized window. The argument above supplies the actual inversion, integrated central errors and high-frequency cutoff that are needed.

A.4 Monotone removal of smoothing at all endpoints

Monotonicity immediately gives

$$N(x) \leq \frac{N_\delta(x + h\delta)}{\Phi(h)}. \quad (\text{A.13})$$

For the opposite direction, split the expectation defining $N_\delta(x - h\delta)$ at $G = h$. The part $G \leq h$ is at most $N(x)$. For the other part apply (4.1) and the Gaussian exponential-tail identity to obtain

$$N_\delta(x - h\delta) \leq N(x) + e^{F(t)+tx} e^{(t\delta)^2/2 - t\delta h} \{1 - \Phi(h - t\delta)\}. \quad (\text{A.14})$$

For small t , $h - t\delta > 0$. The normal tail bound and the exact cancellation

$$(t\delta)^2/2 - t\delta h - (h - t\delta)^2/2 = -h^2/2 = -10L \quad (\text{A.15})$$

show that the additive error, normalized by e^{F+tx} , is $\mathcal{O}(t^{10}/\sqrt{L})$. Also $1 - \Phi(h) = \mathcal{O}(t^{10}/\sqrt{L})$. The main terms of (A.9) at the two shifted arguments differ from the unshifted one by

$$e^{\pm th\delta} = 1 + \mathcal{O}(tL). \quad (\text{A.16})$$

Since the unshifted normalized main term has order t , both inequalities prove (A.1). Every step holds for $N_{\leq}$ as well. This proves (A.1), including at atoms and without rounding the endpoint.

References

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